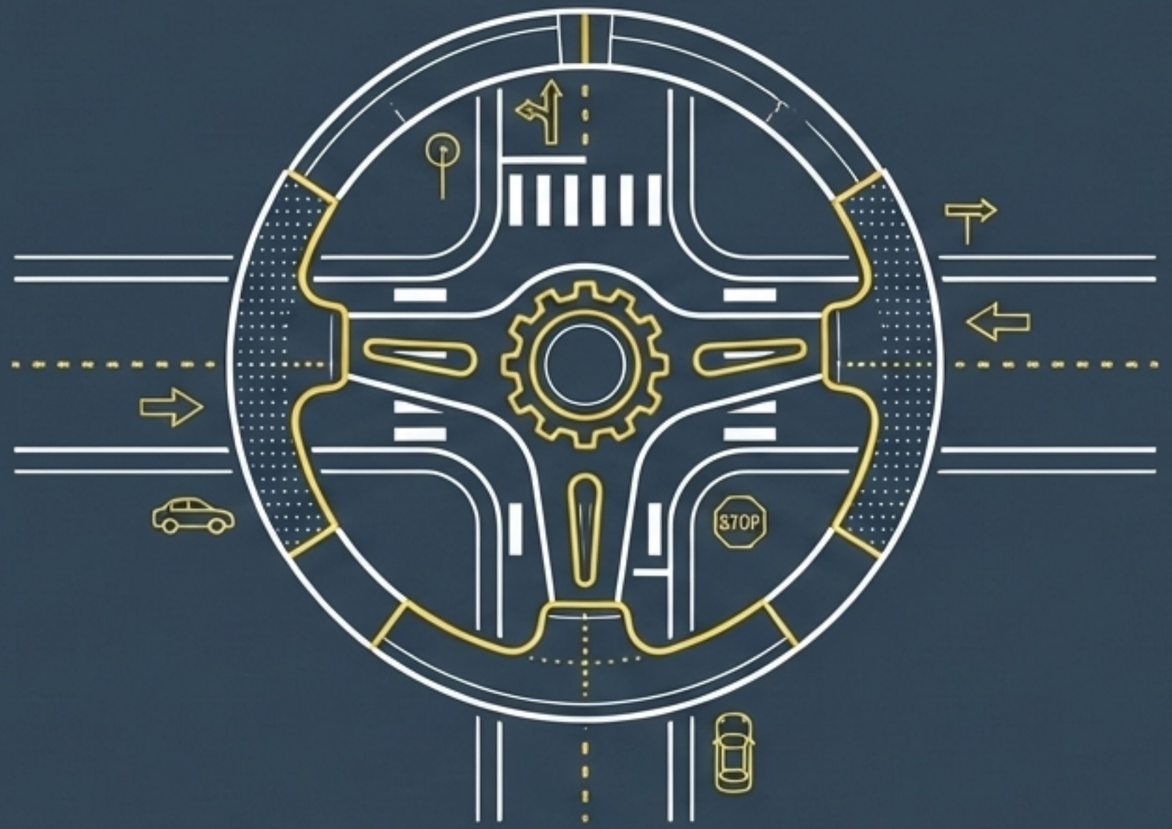
Permit to Pavement

The Oklahoma Driver's Blueprint



NotebookLM

The Graduated Driver License (GDL) Timeline

Level 1: Learner Permit

- Age 15 or 15.5
- Requires approved Driver's Ed enrollment (if 15).
- Restriction 9: Must be accompanied by licensed driver 21+ in front seat.
- Restriction T: Driving allowed only between 5:00 a.m. and 10:00 p.m.

Level 2: Intermediate License

- Age 16+
- Must hold Permit for 180 days + complete 50 hours of practice.
- Passenger restrictions apply.

Level 3: Unrestricted License

- Age 16.5 or 18
- Full driving freedom.
- No passenger or time restrictions.

NotebookLM

Choosing Your Driver's Ed Pathway

Public School

- Managed through the secondary school system.
- Provides a notarized completion form.
- Qualifies to waive the DMV written knowledge test.

Commercial School

- Private driving schools.
- Provides an enrollment contract or completion certificate.
- Qualifies to waive the DMV written knowledge test.

Parent-Taught (PTDE)

- The most flexible option.
- 30 hours classroom / 55 hours behind-the-wheel.

CRITICAL ALERT: You must receive an official approval email and number from Service Oklahoma **BEFORE** purchasing a Parent-Taught course.

WARNING: Parent-Taught Driver Ed does NOT qualify to waive the written knowledge test at the DMV. Commercial and Public options do.

NotebookLM

The Service Oklahoma “Go-Bag”



1. Proof of Identity

- Certified original only (No photocopies/notarized copies).

- Valid US Passport OR Certified Birth Certificate.



2. Proof of Residency

- Must show physical address.

- Utility bill, bank statement, or cell phone bill.

- Must be dated within the last 60 days.



3. SSN & Parent

- Must know Social Security Number (physical card not required).

- If under 18, a parent or legal guardian **MUST** be present.



4. Driver’s Ed Proof

- Public/Commercial completion certificate, OR

- Parent-Taught Affidavit approval number + proof of purchase.

SERVICE OKLAHOMA

NotebookLM

Inside Intel: The Written Knowledge Test

The Specs

- **Format:** 20-question multiple-choice exam.
- **Passing Fee:** $42.50 to print and issue the Permit.
- **Failing Fee:** $4.00 added for each failed attempt (paid upon passing).
- Failures require a mandatory 1-day wait before retesting.

Field Notes / Reddit Intel



The Manual is King

Do not rely exclusively on online practice tests; they can set you up for failure. Read the actual Oklahoma manual.



School Bus Heavy

Expect multiple questions regarding exactly when and where to stop for school buses.



Tricky Wording

Know the "3-Second Rule," but be prepared for questions that frame it simply as maintaining a "safe driving distance."

NotebookLM

Rules of the Road: Right-of-Way

The 4-Way Stop

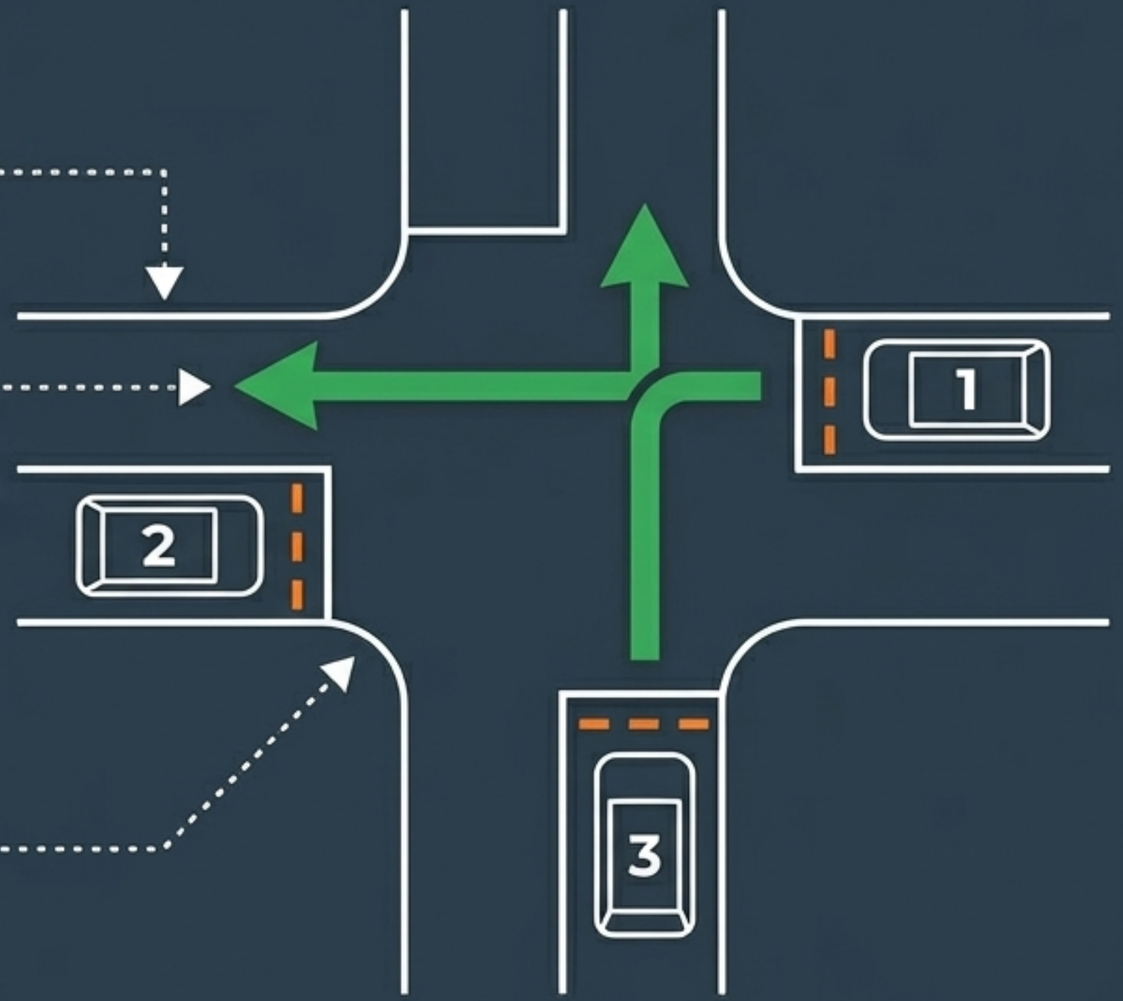
First to arrive, first to drive. If two vehicles arrive at the exact same time, the driver on the left ALWAYS yields to the driver on the right.

Left Turns

When making a left turn, you must yield to all oncoming traffic. Go only when there is clear distance.

Pedestrian Absolute

Drivers must give the absolute right-of-way to any blind person crossing the street (identified by a white cane or guide dog). Stop at least 15 feet away.



NotebookLM

The Highway Decoder Ring: Signs & Lines

Colors



Regulatory (Stop, Yield, Do Not Enter)



General Warning (Hazards ahead)



Construction/ Maintenance (Alert: Fines double here)

Shapes



Complete Stop.



Warning/ Hazard.

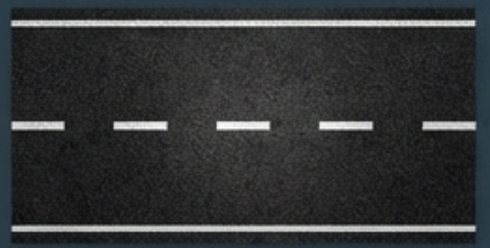


Yield.

Pavement Markings



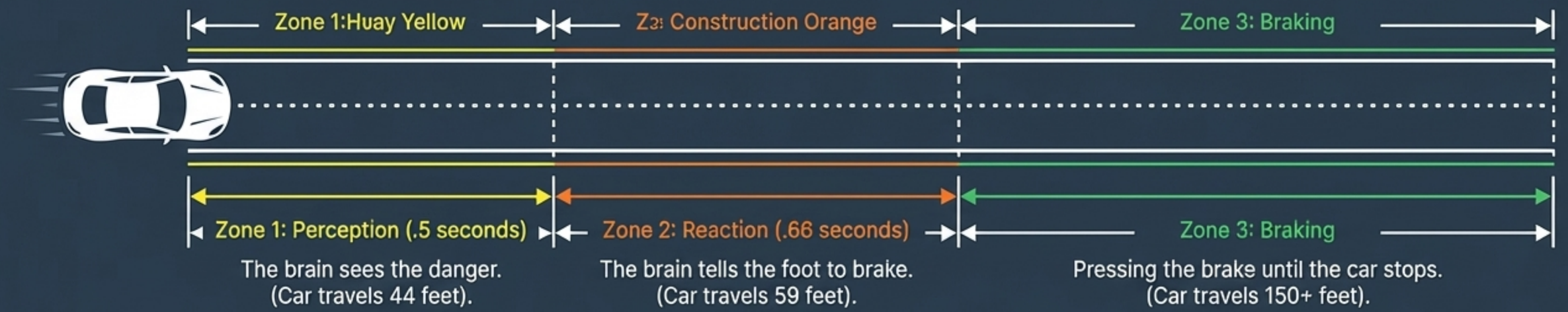
Inter
Two-way traffic. Do Not Pass.



Inter
Traffic moves in the same direction. Passing permitted.

NotebookLM

The Physics of Stopping: The 3-Second Rule



The 3-Second Rule



Watch the vehicle ahead pass a fixed point (like a tree).

Count 1-Mississippi, 2-Mississippi, 3-Mississippi.

If you pass the point before 3, you are following too closely. Increase to 4 seconds in bad weather.

Hydroplaning Alert

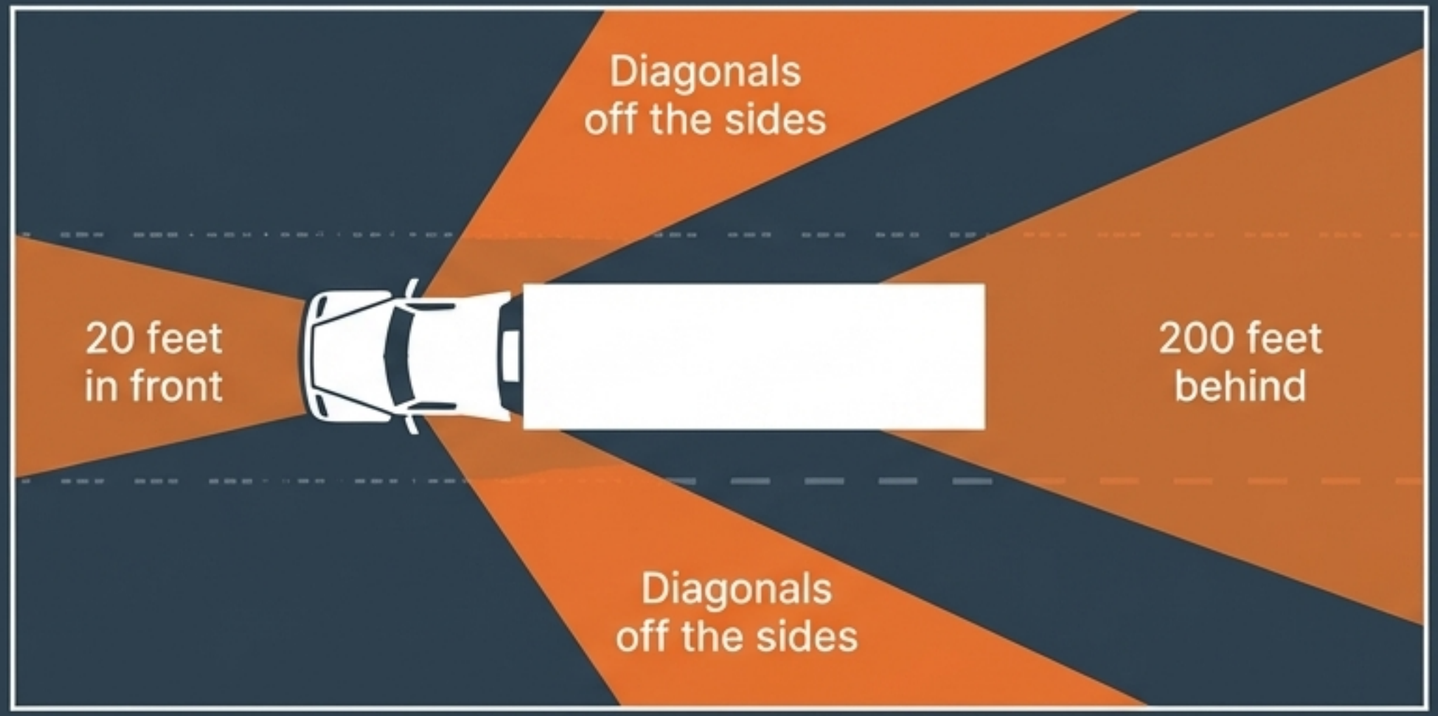


If tires ride on a film of water, ease off the gas and steer straight. Never slam the brakes.

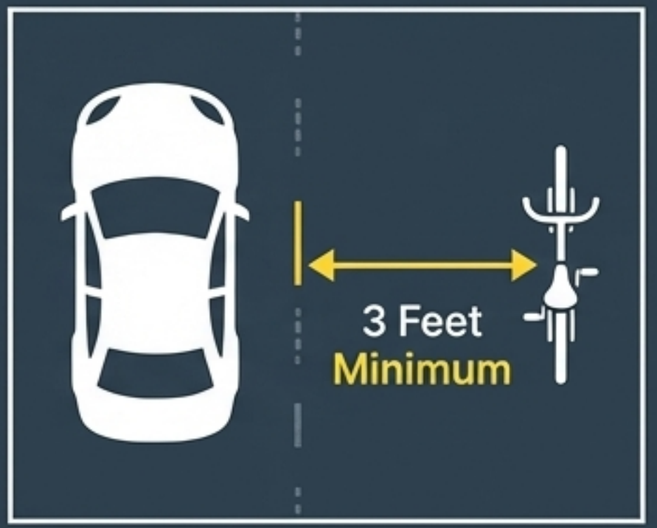
(Note: 2 feet of water will float most vehicles).

NotebookLM

Sharing the Road: Big Rigs & Bicycles



- If you cannot see the truck's mirrors, the driver cannot see you.
- Pass confidently on the left. Never linger alongside a truck.
- Beware the "Right Turn Squeeze"—trucks make wide right turns and may swing left first.



- Bicyclists have the same rights as motor vehicles.
- Leave a mandatory minimum of 3 feet of clearance when passing.
- Never pass a bicycle if the street is too narrow or if oncoming cars are present.

NotebookLM

The Danger Zones: High-Alert Scenarios



School Buses

You MUST stop for a school bus with flashing red lights and an extended stop arm. Exception: You do not have to stop if you are on the opposite side of a physical divided highway.



Railroad Crossings

Stop 15 to 50 feet from the nearest rail. Trains traveling 55mph take over a mile to stop. If your car stalls on the tracks, get out immediately and run at a 45-degree angle TOWARD the direction the train is coming from.





The Move Over Law

When approaching stationary vehicles with flashing lights on the shoulder, you are legally required to move over one lane. If you cannot safely change lanes, you must slow down and proceed with caution.

NotebookLM

State of Mind: Zero Tolerance



Zero Tolerance (Under 21)

Oklahoma enforces absolute zero tolerance. Any measurable amount of alcohol for drivers under 21 results in immediate license revocation.



Implied Consent

By operating a vehicle in Oklahoma, you automatically agree to blood alcohol testing. Refusal results in automatic license revocation for 180 days to 2 years.



Distracted Driving

Texting while driving is strictly illegal in Oklahoma. Using a hand-held electronic device can result in the suspension or cancellation of a Learner Permit.

NotebookLM

You Passed the Written Test! Now What?

Countdown to the Drive Test

Requirement 1: The Holding Period

You must hold the Learner Permit for a minimum of 180 days.

Requirement 2: The 50 Hours

Complete 50 hours of behind-the-wheel practice with a licensed driver (21+). At least 10 of these hours must be driven at night.

Requirement 3: Work Zone Safe

If under 18, you must complete the free online Oklahoma Work Zone Safe Course and obtain the certificate.

Requirement 4: Clean Record

You must have absolutely zero traffic convictions on your driving record during the permit phase.

NotebookLM

The Parent “Co-Pilot” Strategy

Getting a license is a partnership. Frame the 50 hours of practice as a structured methodology, not a chore.



Pillar 1: Empty Lot Foundations

Spend the first 4 hours exclusively in empty parking lots. Mastery of the brake/gas feel must happen before a single competing car is nearby.



Pillar 2: Commentary Driving

Ask the teen to “Narrate the Road” out loud (e.g., “Checking left mirror,” “Light turning yellow”). This builds situational awareness without parent nagging.



Pillar 3: The “No-Correction” Zone

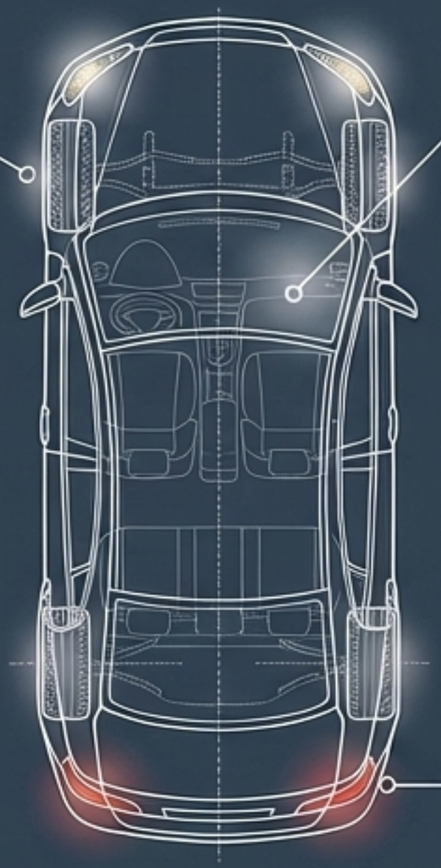
Unless it’s a safety emergency, do not verbally correct minor steering drift. Let them feel the car drift and learn to self-correct. If voices rise, the lesson is over. Swap seats and try again tomorrow.

NotebookLM

The Drive Test Blueprint

Pre-Flight Vehicle Inspection
Pre-Flight Vehicle Inspection

Tires: Minimum 2/32" tread depth (use the penny test).



Windshield: No major cracks. No tint below the AS-1 line.

Operational: Working brakes, turn signals, and horn (audible at 200 ft). Current Insurance verification.



The Graded Maneuvers
The Graded Maneuvers

The Cockpit Drill
Adjusting seat, mirrors, and seatbelt BEFORE moving.

Reverse Control
Backing up slowly in a straight line for 50 feet while looking over the shoulder.

Parking
Parallel parking and proper wheel orientation for parking on hills.

Created with love from Momma 💕(angieCREATEs)

NotebookLM

READY TO ROLL



Step 1: Assemble the Go-Bag (ID, Residency, SSN).

Step 2: SOK Approval (If choosing Parent-Taught).

Step 3: Pass the Written Knowledge Test & Vision Screening.

Step 4: Execute the 50-Hour Practice Strategy (180-day wait).

Step 5: Pass the Vehicle Inspection and Drive Test.

Keep this blueprint in the glovebox. Drive defensively, drive friendly. Think of the right-of-way as something to be given, not taken.

NotebookLM